

Mauch Named to Succeed Sawyer As Phils' Manager

By RUSS GREEN

PHILADELPHIA (UPI) — The Philadelphia Phillies, still shaken by the surprise resignation of Manager Eddie Sawyer, awaited the arrival of new skipper Gene Mauch today to take over as the third pilot of the club in three days.

Sawyer, the only two-time manager of the team in its 84-year history, resigned with startling suddenness Thursday. Coach Andy Cohen led the Phillies to a 10-inning 5-4 victory in Thursday night's game with Milwaukee and the peppery Mauch was scheduled to reach Philadelphia from Florida today.

The club's front office, beginning with President Bob Carpenter through General Manager John Quinn and right down to the team itself insisted that Sawyer's decision was a bolt from the blue, a real shocker.

"Never an Inkling"

Quinn, awaiting the early afternoon arrival of Mauch, who left as manager of Minneapolis to take over the Phillies, said, "I rode in from Cincinnati on the plane with Eddie. We sat together. We had dinner together. We picked up our luggage together. There was never an inkling of his decision."

He had asked Sawyer to reconsider during the phone call of resignation and commented he would still be the manager if he wanted to.

Quinn also said there was no disagreement between Sawyer and him on personal matters, adding, "I never interefered with any manager and I never will."

The Phils' general manager, who recommended Mauch for his managerial job at Atlanta, ticked off the reasons for his choice over pilots in the Phils' chain in the face of the newcomer's minor league record of a third place finish with Atlanta and second and third in two seasons at Minneapolis.

Has Ambition, Determination

"He gets along with people and will get along with ball players," Quinn said, explaining swiftly that it was no reference to reports that Sawyer had lost the confidence of his team.

"Mauch was not a great ball player but he gave 100 per cent of what he had and he was always trying to improve himself. He paid attention to whomever he played for," Quinn continued.

"He learned all phases of the game. He wants to do well—and he won't do it halfway. He has great ambition, desire and determination."

Quinn added, "more than I among baseball men share the opinion that he is one of the better young managers coming along in the game."